

Calvin Isley

Harvard Kennedy School of Government
Cambridge, MA 02139

cisley@g.harvard.edu
calvinisley.com

Research Interests: *AI in education, university admissions, and algorithmic decision-making*

EDUCATION

Harvard Kennedy School

Ph.D. in Public Policy

Cambridge, MA

August 2024 – Present

Washington University in St. Louis

Bachelor of Arts – Economics and Computer Science (magna cum laude)

St. Louis, MO

August 2018 – May 2022

Minors: *Mathematics, Chinese*

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- [1] **Assessing the Quality of AI-Generated Exams: A Large-Scale Field Study.** Calvin Isley, Joshua Gilbert, Evangelos Kassos, Michaela Kocher, Allen Nie, Emma Brunskill, Ben Domingue, Jake Hofman, Joscha Legewie, Teddy Svoronos, Charlotte Tuminelli, Sharad Goel. *Proceedings of the Fortieth AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI 2026)*. Oral Presentation. 2026.
- [2] **Money Market Fund Repo and the ON RRP Facility.** Samuel J. Hempel, Calvin Isley, R. Jay Kahn, Patrick E. McCabe. *FEDS Notes*. 2023.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

- [1] **AI-written admissions essays are widespread but penalized.** Calvin Isley, Johann D. Gaebler, Sharad Goel. *Working paper*. 2026.
- [2] **Receptiveness, Not Sycophancy: Distinguishing Engagement from Deference in Language Models.** Calvin Isley, Johann D. Gaebler, Max Lamparth, Julia Minson, Sharad Goel. *Under review*. 2026.
- [3] **Reassessing the Role of Standardized Tests in University Admissions.** Johann D. Gaebler, Calvin Isley, Christopher Avery, Sharad Goel. *NBER Working Paper No. 35407*. 2026.
- [4] **Mitigating Label Bias with Interpretable Rubric Embeddings.** Calvin Isley, Johann D. Gaebler, Sharad Goel. *Under review*. 2026.
- [5] **Making Alignment Tradeoffs Transparent with Rubric-Based Rewards.** Johann D. Gaebler, Calvin Isley, Sharad Goel. *Working paper*.
- [6] **AI Tutoring and Teacher Support Tools for Elementary Education.** Madison Coots, Calvin Isley, Elisa Xi Chen, Nick Masi, Joe Nudell, Charlotte Tuminelli, Teddy Svoronos, Sharad Goel. *Working paper*.

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

INFORMS Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST)

San Francisco, CA, October 2026

- “Mitigating Label Bias with Interpretable Rubric Embeddings”
- “AI Use in Graduate Applications is Common but Penalized”

ACM EAAMO

Munich, Germany, November 2026

- “Mitigating Label Bias with Interpretable Rubric Embeddings” (Oral)
- “AI Use in Graduate Applications is Common but Penalized” (Oral)

International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2)

Burlington, VT, July 2026

- “AI Use in Graduate Applications is Common but Penalized” (Parallel talk)

- “Evidence on the Quality of Verbal and Written AI-Generated Assessments” (Invited talk)

TEACHING

Harvard Kennedy School of Government

- **Teaching Fellow (appointed).** API 232A: Computational Policy Analysis: Data, Decisions, and Evidence (Fall 2026).
- **Teaching Fellow.** DPI 681: Public Problem Solving with Generative AI: Challenges and Opportunities (Spring 2026). *Designed assignments and course materials; led breakout sections teaching coding fundamentals.*
- **Teaching Fellow.** DPI 681M: The Science and Implications of Generative AI (Spring 2025, Fall 2025; appointed for Fall 2026). *Designed and taught the technical complement to the course on data analysis, RAG, agents, and fine-tuning.*

Howard University

- **Teaching Assistant.** ECON 181: Data Analysis and Financial Literacy in R (Fall 2022, Fall 2024). *Assisted with lecture delivery and developed course AI use policy.*

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Invited Reviewer: AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI 2027), AI for Social Impact Track; ACM Web Conference (The WebConf 2025), Responsible Web Track

SKILLS SUMMARY

Languages: R, Python

AI: LLM prompt and response evaluation, AI-generated content assessment, text data processing and information extraction, RAG and agent system design, chatbot design and user experience for AI systems

Methods: Statistical inference, causal inference, machine learning, econometric analysis, experimental design

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Research Assistant

Federal Reserve Board of Governors, Division of Research and Statistics

Washington, DC

August 2022 – August 2024